



opponents, Holloway is content on conserving energy early before steadily increasing the pressure and forcing exchanges that few fighters can sustain.

Cardio remains perhaps the biggest unknown heading into this fight. McGregor has not competed in nearly five years because of injuries and setbacks, making it difficult to know how he will respond if the bout

becomes a gruelling championship-distance contest. Holloway, meanwhile, has repeatedly proven he can maintain his output for all five rounds. He boasts an average of 6.91 significant strikes per minute, compared to McGregor's 5.32.

Ultimately, the tactical blueprint is straightforward. McGregor needs an efficient performance built around



Did you know?

Conor McGregor made his professional boxing debut against arguably the greatest boxer of his generation. McGregor, who had never fought a professional boxing match, stepped into the ring in 2017 against Floyd Mayweather Jr. **(pic, left)**, who was 49-0 at the time. Despite the 10th-round TKO loss, the event was one of the biggest combat sports spectacles ever, generating well over four million pay-per-view buys.

timing, precision and an early finish. Every minute beyond the second round favours Holloway, whose pressure, output and conditioning become increasingly difficult to handle.

This is essentially a race against the clock. If McGregor lands his signature left hand before Holloway settles into his rhythm, he could pull off one of the greatest comebacks in UFC history. But if Holloway survives the early storm, the odds could shift heavily in his favour.

While McGregor vs Holloway headlines the event, UFC 329 is stacked with high-stakes matchups from top to bottom.

The co-main event pits Benoit Saint Denis against Paddy Pimblett in a lightweight bout with title implications. Saint Denis brings elite grappling, while Pimblett's unpredictable striking and submission game make him one of the division's biggest attractions.

At bantamweight, Cory Sandhagen faces Mario Bautista in a pivotal clash that could reshape the title picture.

Elsewhere, former middleweight title challenger Robert Whittaker makes his light heavyweight debut against the dangerous Nikita Krylov, while fan favourite Cody Garbrandt faces heavy-handed Adrian Yanez in what promises to be an explosive striking battle.